

The First Scanner

Circa 1985, Microtek International Inc. introduced the world's first scanner—a black and white—called the MS-300A, which had publishing software, called EyeStar, bundled with it. This software became the de-facto standard for importing graphics before the TIFF format was envisaged. It would take another 12 years before the first scanner was introduced by the same company.

The Amiga 1000 offered stunning graphics and sound for the time; moreover, the AmigaDOS OS had a GUI that resembled the UNIX GUI and was designed for multitasking. It lost its popularity a year later when its successor, the Amiga 500, was launched.

July: PageMaker For The Mac

In 1985, the art of phototypesetting was not yet fully evolved. What you saw on-screen was not always what you got on paper. Things got a little better when Adobe released its PostScript page description language for the Apple Macintosh. Then Paul Brainerd of Aldus Corporation came out with PageMaker for Macintosh in July of 1985, and all hell broke loose!

The PageMaker software was groundbreaking. For the first time, users could actually create their own art right on the computer. The software relied on Adobe's PostScript page description language and used the Apple LaserWriter, a PostScript compatible laser printer for output. Aldus Corporation released the PageMaker for the PC a year later but by then the Macintosh had already become the de facto standard for a new industry it had helped create: an industry called Desktop Publishing (DTP), which used a computer with page layout software to create documents for publishing.

It was only after half a decade that competing software QuarkXpress started to gain ground on PageMaker. The mystery of why Adobe never released its own DTP software was solved in September 1994, when it bought over Aldus Corporation and with it the PageMaker software.